> Once you start moving, you never stop. That's what I told my sons when they took the trains. I said: I don't believe in this India-Shindia. It's all very well, you're going away now, but suppose when you get there they decide to draw another line somewhere? What will you do then? Where will you move to? No one will have you anywhere. As for me, I was born here, and I'll die here.

In order to heal the wounds of Partition, the Liaquat-Nehru pact was signed in April 1950 between India and Pakistan, which among other things proposed to set up minority commissions and allow the displaced to return unharmed to dispose of their property. Migrations on the eastern front were unbalanced towards India and evacuee land was inadequate to settle the incoming migrants. By 1951, only half the number of displaced families had been resettled.[37] Two townships at Habra-Baigachi and Fulia in West Bengal were being built and numerous extensions were built to existing towns. Close to 40,000 'unattached' women and children were being looked after as the state's responsibility.[38] Government officials were providing relief work but had kept rehabilitation plans on hold in the expectation that a large number of migrants would go back across the border. They never did. In fact, many of the Muslim evacuees returned to West Bengal.

Three years later, in June 1953, a detailed survey-based report by West Bengal government officials, on the conditions of the displaced, was published. It argued that permanent rehabilitation had to be top priority to 'avoid forced idleness' in the transit camps, which was demoralizing.[39] The report recommended the dispersal of people from transit camps to rehabilitation centres and work sites. Among new initiatives, the Dandakaranya project was the most ambitious as it entailed starting a resettlement zone in the wilderness bordering western Orissa and Chhattisgarh.[40] The project was marred with a lot of problems as the migrants sent there, mostly low-caste, would return to West Bengal in the absence of good facilities and employment opportunities. The Andaman and Nicobar Islands was another site where a few thousand migrants were sent. But by and large, Assam, West Bengal and the region surrounding Calcutta in particular continued to be the mainstay of the migrants.